number of huts in the garden of No. 10 whose responsibilities appeared to be everything from drafting Lloyd George's speeches to making special enquiries on his behalf.[16] By giving men such as his private secretary, Philip Kerr, such a wide remit, the prime minister effectively circumvented the Foreign Office and undermined its traditional role as sole advisor on foreign affairs.[17] The feeling that the Foreign Office was being usurped was compounded by the creation, at the same time, of the Cabinet Secretariat.[18] While the Cabinet Secretariat's role was essentially administrative, it also included the organisation of international conferences, and the handling of relations with the League of Nations.[19] In the eyes of many contemporaries both the Cabinet Secretariat and the Garden Suburb were part of Lloyd George's 'system', and represented his prime ministerial style of government, often seen as domineering and dictatorial.[20]

The Foreign Office had always believed that it was the only body with expertise to present foreign policy issues clearly and objectively.[21] In the post-war period, however, it would seem that anyone within the government could express their opinion on foreign affairs, a trend the Foreign Office deeply resented. As Eyre Crowe (assistant under-secretary of state) put it:

This growing system of enquiring into other people's conduct by unqualified outsiders instead of entrusting the proper administration of an office to its own responsible head is going to introduce more and more anarchy into the whole service...[22]

Clashes between the War Office and Foreign Office over foreign policy were almost as frequent as those with Lloyd George. Charles Hardinge (permanent under-secretary of state from 1916 to 1920) caustically observed: 'All soldiers regard themselves as Heaven born diplomatists and much prefer diplomacy to military strategy…'[23] As shall be seen, even the India Office would not escape Foreign Office censure when it tried to weigh in on foreign affairs. Coping with a distrustful prime minister, as well as facing various forms of rivalry for its remit over foreign relations, it is perhaps no wonder that the demise of Foreign Office powers has been a